



Bezos steps down from Amazon

Jeff Bezos steps down from Amazon exactly 27 years after he founded it.
<https://digit.in/jul21-81>



Google Play ditched .apk

Starting from August, Play will use 'Android App Bundles' (.aab) instead of APKs.
<https://digit.in/jul21-82>

NFT only represents the ownership of the media that is linked to the NFT. Ownership of an NFT does not automatically confer rights to the digital asset represented by the token. While someone may sell an NFT representing their work, the buyer does not always get copyright protections when ownership of the NFT changes, and the original owner is free to produce more NFTs of the same work. In that respect, an NFT is just separate evidence of ownership from copyright. Unless specifically transferred, they do not hold the copyright to the underlying work. What exactly are you buying? This is not the same as comparing an art piece to a fake print when the copies are noticeably different from the original. It is easy to create copies of the tokenised artwork since it is in a digital format. You don't have a special version that only you can enjoy, effectively only giving you bragging rights of owning the artwork.

Now, let's look at how NFT works on a fundamental level. Due to the file size, most NFTs containing digital art do not keep it on the blockchain. The token acts more like a certificate of ownership, with a web address pointing to the piece of art in question, implying that the art is still vulnerable to link rot, i.e. a link that

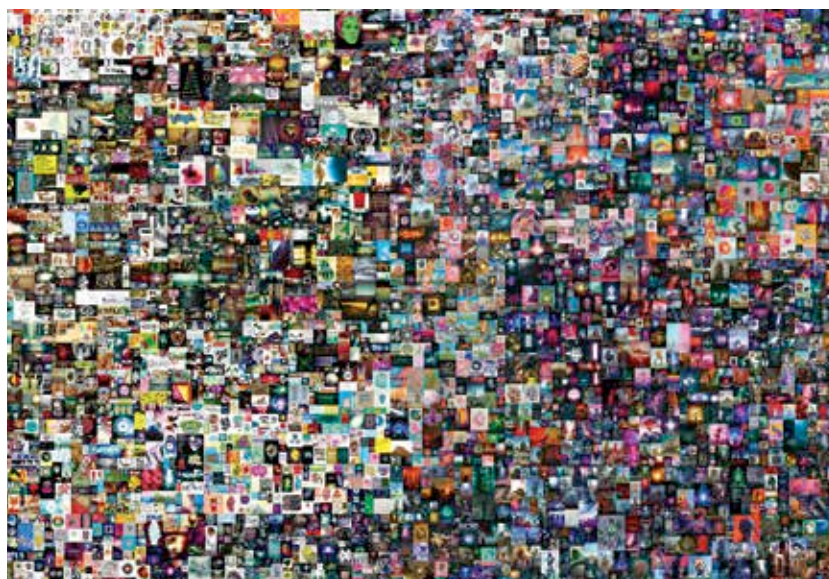
no longer points to its target. NFT owners may find themselves in one of two situations: the first is that they own an NFT with a broken link, but they and the rest of the world know what artwork used to represent. The NFT may retain value as long as that image exists somewhere in the world and the creator, owner, and prospective purchasers all agree on what the token represents. After all, it is a trust-based system. In the other case, the image has disappeared, and no one knows what artwork the NFT was formerly connected with. If that's the case, it's difficult to see the NFT having any benefit at all. A ruined painting or a vanished statue cannot be sold. And an NFT that lacks art to look at is simply that - nothing to look at. This begs the question as to why NFTs are valued so much because there is a high chance, years down the line, it's an expensive 404 error and not a piece of art.

There is a case to be made that NFTs benefit digital artists by allowing them to be rewarded for their efforts. NFTs are not a gift to aspiring artists. Theoretically, NFTs cannot be copied, and are a way to make sure that there are no more starving artists, by allowing them to get a cut every time the NFT is resold in the market. However, the

problem is that it does not really work that way, and there is nothing stopping people from minting their own versions of pirated art. nullifying the primary value proposition of NFTs. NFTs are a scourge that facilitates art theft. Many creators' material is being stolen, prompting artists to take down their artwork from Twitter or even go private to prevent their content from being stolen and tokenised. Images may now be readily duplicated, reproduced, and disseminated online, with little or no acknowledgement given to the original artist. And honestly, if people want a one-of-a-kind piece of art, then commission an artist. This guarantees that artists are appropriately compensated for their labour. Hire an artist if you're concerned about the future of the arts.

Then there's the problem of NFTs being stolen, to begin with. In NFTs or blockchain, there is no security against theft. Every transaction — even those that are essentially theft — is functionally permanent since the blockchain record is irreversible and there is no centralised authority to govern it. Even if they are the owner, if someone gets into your NFT account and transfers the money to them, there is nothing you can do. There is no central bank, no central authority, and no central authority to contact. In their early phases, new technologies are generally the most susceptible.

The concept of an NFT is capitalism in its distilled form. They're the ugly outcome of a toxic urge to own things that don't need to be owned just to have them. They're nothing more than pure ego crystallised, digitised, and monetized. NFTs do not have any necessities or benefits. The only meagre benefit of purchasing an NFT is the opportunity to brag about owning an NFT, a statement so meaningless it is comical. It is ruining the Earth and everyone on it in order to offer that insignificant, useless, and revolting digital tokens, that just need to be burned from the blockchain. 🔥



Beeple's \$69K NFT